

I. Introduction to Global Sustainability Agenda 2030

- **Definition:** A universal roadmap to achieve equitable, prosperous, and sustainable development by 2030.
- **SDGs vs. MDGs:** Unlike the incremental Millennium Development Goals (MDGs), Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) aim for systemic changes across economic, social, and environmental dimensions.
- **Core Objective:** The principle of "no one is left behind," ensuring inclusive progress for all.
- **Pakistan's Adoption:** Pakistan adopted this agenda to tackle challenges like poverty, inequality, education, healthcare, and environmental sustainability.
- **Shift in Sustainability:** The definition has evolved from simply balancing resource consumption to an urgent need to preserve the planet.

II. Key Features of SDGs

- **Universal Call:** Includes eradicating poverty/hunger, improving health/education, gender equality, clean water/energy, and climate action.
- **Goal Evolution:** While MDGs focused on reducing hunger/poverty, SDGs aim to end them entirely.
- **Distinguishing Features:** Universality, comprehensiveness, and integrated ambition, applicable to all developed and developing nations.
- **Core Principles:** Evidence-based decision-making, multi-stakeholder partnerships, and accountability.

III. Pakistan's National Priorities (Categories)

Pakistan has categorized the 17 SDGs into three groups based on urgency.

Category 1: Immediate Attention (Highest Priority)

- **Goal 2 (Zero Hunger):** Top priority due to food crises and inflation.
- **Goal 3 (Good Health & Well-being):** Focus on healthcare facilities, life expectancy, and epidemic control.
- **Goal 4 (Quality Education):** Crucial as ~22.8 million children are out of school; focuses on infrastructure and access.

- **Goal 6 (Clean Water & Sanitation):** To ensure hygienic environments and reduce waterborne diseases.
- **Goal 7 (Affordable & Clean Energy):** Extending electricity to hard-to-reach areas via wind, solar, and hydro projects.
- **Goal 8 (Decent Work & Economic Growth):** Focus on economic sustainability and employment.

Category 2 & 3 Priorities

- **Category 2:** Goal 1 (No Poverty), Goal 5 (Gender Equality), Goal 9 (Industry), Goal 10 (Inequality), Goal 11 (Sustainable Cities), Goal 17 (Partnerships) .
- **Category 3:** Goal 12 (Consumption), Goal 14 (Life Below Water), Goal 15 (Life on Land), and Goal 13 (Climate Action—critical due to recent floods) .

IV. Analysis of Annual Status Report (2021)

- **Global Ranking:** Pakistan ranked **129th out of 165** countries (compared to Bangladesh at 120 and India at 116).

Progress by Goal:

- **SDG 1 (No Poverty):** Steady progress; **9.3 million** people lifted out of poverty between 2014-2019.
- **SDG 2 (Zero Hunger):** Undernourishment decreased by **4.2%** (from 20.2% to 16%); poverty at \$1.90/day improved to 0.2%.
- **SDG 3 (Health):** Modest progress; maternal mortality reduced by **32.6%** (2007-2019); skilled birth attendance increased by 10%.
- **SDG 4 (Education): Dismal progress;** completion rate stagnated at 67% and literacy at 60% (2015-2020).
- **SDG 5 (Gender Equality):** Women in managerial positions doubled (**2.7% to 4.53%**); physical violence dropped 5.3% overall but remains high in KPK and Baluchistan.
- **SDG 6 (Water):** **94%** of the population has access to drinking water; Baluchistan saw a 17% increase.
- **SDG 7 (Energy):** Clean fuel usage rose from 41.3% to **47%**.
- **SDG 8 (Economy):** Slow progress; GDP per capita declined by **-3.36%** in 2019-2020.

- **SDG 9 (Industry):** Small-scale industry contribution rose to **10.5%**.
- **SDG 10 (Inequality):** Income inequality reduced by **2%**.
- **SDG 11 (Cities):** Slum population declined **7%**; inadequate housing dropped 38%, but **45%** still live in informal settlements.
- **SDG 13 (Climate):** Index score improved (0.4 to 0.8), but GHG emissions increased by **2.6% annually**.
- **SDG 17 (Partnerships):** Fixed broadband subscriptions increased by **20%**.

V. Federal and Institutional Initiatives

- **Parliamentary Role:** Pakistan was the first country to formally approve SDGs as a national agenda on Feb 16, 2016.
- **Established SDG Units:**
 - **Prime Minister's Office Unit:** Oversees initiatives; allocated **~Rs 55 billion** (Rs 12 billion specifically for water/electricity).
 - **Parliament Unit:** Led by the National Assembly Speaker; annual budget of **Rs 30 billion**.
 - **Planning Commission Unit:** Focuses on policy coordination and integration.
- **Key Supporting Institutions:**
 - **Ministry of Climate Change:** Aligns with SDG 13.
 - **Ministry of Federal Education:** Works on SDG 4 (infrastructure/access).
 - **National Commission on the Status of Women (NCSW):** Works on SDG 5.
 - **National Rural Support Program (NRSP):** NGOs for rural poverty/health.
 - **Pakistan Poverty Alleviation Fund (PPAF):** Supports SDG 1.
 - **Sustainable Development Policy Institute (SDPI):** Think tank for research and policy.

VI. CPEC's Contribution to SDGs

- **Infrastructure (SDG 9):** Roads, railways, and ports improve connectivity and trade.
- **Energy (SDG 7):** Coal, hydro, and renewable projects increase energy capacity.

- **Economic Growth (SDG 8):** Special Economic Zones (SEZs) create jobs and attract investment.
- **Poverty Reduction (SDG 1 & 10):** Infrastructure and jobs improve living standards and reduce disparities.
- **Regional Connectivity (SDG 17):** Enhances collaboration between China, Pakistan, and neighbors.
- **Phase 2 Focus:** Sustainability, education, technical institutes, and exchange programs.

VII. Challenges to Implementation

- **Economic:** Instability, high inflation, unemployment, fiscal deficits, and lack of funds .
- **External Crises:** COVID-19, floods, and conflicts diverted resources to emergency responses.
- **Political:** Instability, frequent government changes, and weak institutional frameworks disrupt policy continuity.
- **Administrative:** Bureaucratic inefficiencies, lack of coordination, and top-down decision-making that ignores local needs.
- **Social:** Lack of public awareness, gender/regional disparities, and poverty.
- **Data & Governance:** Outdated data systems, corruption, and weak rule of law.

VIII. Recommendations for Improvement

- **Economic:** Stimulate growth, control inflation, and leverage CPEC for connectivity.
- **Financial:** Diversify funding (Public-Private Partnerships, aid) and improve tax collection/fiscal management.
- **Policy & Planning:** Integrate SDGs into national plans, create prioritization frameworks, and publish annual status reports.
- **Rule of Law:** Strengthen legal frameworks and combat financial corruption.
- **Collaboration:** Enhance federal-provincial coordination, engage experts, and use e-governance for citizen participation.
- **Local Focus:** Empower local governments (financial/administrative powers) and adopt a bottom-up approach.

- **Sustainability & Awareness:** Integrate sustainability into all policies, launch awareness campaigns in local languages, and engage youth.
- **Data & Tech:** Modernize data collection systems and build technical expertise.
- **Resilience:** Build systems for disaster preparedness (pandemics/conflicts).